

Problem 5: Dhivehi

(30 marks)

Given below are some sentences in English:

1. I take your chair.
2. The friend accidentally asks the bird.
3. Your child starts (with) the coconut.
4. I will accidentally start the white fire.
5. The fire takes the tasty coconut.
6. You will drop the small child.
7. The child accidentally takes the chair.
8. The donkey will accidentally drop the banana.
9. The bird's friend will ask me.
10. The white banana will start the fire.
11. I will hit the donkey.
12. The friend's bird will look at the fire.
13. The child looks at the tasty coconut.
14. The donkey accidentally hits the small chair.
15. The white coconut accidentally hits the chair.
16. You accidentally ask the friend.
17. The bird will accidentally drop the tasty banana.
18. The donkey accidentally looks at the small banana.

And here are their translations into Dhivehi, in arbitrary order:

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|----------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| A. Aharen himāru jahānan. | J. Raṭṭessa' dūni ehē. |
| B. Aharena' hudu alifān feṣēne. | K. Darifuḷu mīru kāṣi balā. |
| C. Hudu kāṭṭa' goṇḍi jehē. | L. Kalē kuḍa darifuḷu vaṭṭāne. |
| D. Himāra' donkeyo veṭṭēne. | M. Dūñña' mīru donkeyo veṭṭēne. |
| E. Aharen kalēge goṇḍi nagan. | N. Hudu donkeyo alifān faṣāne. |
| F. Raṭṭehīge dūni alifān balāne. | O. Kalēge darifuḷu kāṣi faṣā. |
| G. Alifān mīru kāṣi nagā. | P. Himāra' kuḍa goṇḍi jehē. |
| H. Kalēa' raṭṭehi ehē. | Q. Darifuḷa' goṇḍi negē. |
| I. Dūñge raṭṭehi aharen ahāne. | R. Himāra' kuḍa donkeyo belē. |

Assignment 1 (9 marks)

Determine the correct correspondences.

Assignment 2 (4 marks)

Translate into Dhivehi:

- (a) The white donkey hits the small banana.
 - (b) I accidentally ask you.
 - (c) Your child will accidentally start the coconut's fire.
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(d) Your fire will accidentally start my fire.

Assignment 3 (4 marks)

Translate into English:

- (a) Aharena' dūni veṭṭēne.
- (b) Aharenge raṭṭehīge raṭṭessa' kalēge raṭṭehīge raṭṭehi jehē.
- (c) Himāru donkeyo balā.
- (d) Darifuḷu alifān faṣāne.

Assignment 4 (13 marks)

Explain any patterns and rules you found in the data.

Dhivehi is an Indo-European language of the Indo-Aryan branch spoken in Maldives. It is the official language of Maldives, and has over 500,000 speakers. It is closely related to Hindi and distantly related to English.

– Advay Misra, Vaageesan Surendran